Comic Writing 101

with Ryan K Lindsay

WHO WANTS TO WRITE COMICS?

Subquestion: Any artists here?

New Question: WHO HAS PUBLISHED STUFF SO FAR?

What have you done?

Let’s Talk Story

Do you have an idea or a story?

What if Batman was the villain? - that’s an idea

How could a foot cop assigned to protect ‘Bruce Wayne’ beat a villain as smart and fluid as Batman? - that’s a story

Let’s Talk Story

Your story will make me care, it’ll have character at its heart and be about their change.

Your idea will make me smirk and nod, but not pay attention for 5 issues.

Think about BLACK SCIENCE

Let’s Talk Story

Is your story interesting enough?

Has it been done before?

Is it predictable?

Will it shock me?

Is it awesome?

Does it make sense?

Breaking Story

Take your time breaking story - the first narrative choices aren’t always the best.

Try many avenues before you commit to what happens next.

Are your character’s making true choices?

Planning V Pantsing

Some people *plan* and some people *pants.*

I am most definitely a planner.

Here’s what a story plan usually looks like for me.

1 Sloane bids Linda. — Max enters. EMP.
CC erupts- Sloane fights for survival. Fortifies boat base.
Max- "there are 17" [illegible] she saved him. Plans their
conversation over bus except it transpires. He gets to the flat.
2022 KILL HER - secret message - in a crowded area - a newspaper to find the words on every article. "The US Cast is [illegible]"
Sloane talks of the criminal bartender. Info dropped - Max enters
starts a fight - tension. - seed planted
WE DON'T KNOW HE'S A SPY - the just seems like a killer.
ABOUT
END - he sees his son outside walking about. TRUSTING
2 - Sloane dinner son but loses him. Copy CC records. It all comes
back to him. He comes to a monster - he attacks it.
Sloane views Max's living memories. A stranger enters.
Gets to the library - discovers where.
Max needs to get to region - a hunt. He must prove
himself he must defeat Lois' operative. He does. Kisses K
Thing comes first - in public - after anyone noticing [illegible]
Librarian wants Sloane to do, one thing.
Kill Max? How he discovers he's in somebody's head.
ABOUT
END - Librarian enters and drops knowledge. DISCOVERY
3 - Session - Sloane dies. Max exit into prison. They can die there.
Do we go into the mine? - [illegible] to kill him.
A fight outside - kid baby toppled, everyone cheering. Kill him" - they know she likes him
Sloane steps in and says [illegible] they fight kill - they'll be helping him out. then
Kills his father a [illegible] Sloane calming - time have it to all Max running after
Max has a goal agent acting tail. He talks to him has a beer.
Opposite thoughts - Max poisons the beer
ABOUT
STANDS CONFIDENCE

4 Girl hunt through library for the lab room - monsters block them.
People die - then Id is gone. Has been for a long time.
Max's mother? died due to protect her son. -
Sloane [illegible] on [illegible] Sloane is angry - blames the library [illegible]
16 Max meets Lois finally. They talk of play Max should believe her boss.
He first met as a spy. He says she knows he's already worked out how to
do it! do it!
Sloane brings out the diary. Things are happening that will [illegible] ABOUT
END - Max will murder the entire family - Sloane takes the diary. WORD TRUST
5 - Sloane sees his son murdered.
Searches for Id - perhaps dissuaded by other Max's they pleads
to at least save [illegible]
16 Takes boat out onto waters [illegible] - Liz killed - escapes back to
Max watches the house, family. Monster in the water.
He arrives at the house in the night Ready to kill. ABOUT MAKING A CHOICE
END - Id arrives on a boat - splashes. Boat made of human pieces.
6 - Id boards, like a gentleman.
Sloane tries to talk him down NO dice. I more thing
Sloane attacks
Max presses through the house, enters the kids room
Son appears. Max's body dumped - Sloane [illegible] ABOUT
END - [illegible]

#1 -

1 - Steve tells about the [illegible] ← insert page of dead body
2 - Steve kicks Linda away
3 - Max - EMP
4 - Max enters the agents and steals a car -
5 - Steve walks through room - EMP attack begins
6 - Steve flies up - CC is fucked up
7 - Max - travel montage. →
8 - He is in a city.
9 - Steve is knocked out of the sky & shrinks.
10 - Steve, naked, and pulls a monster off of Lady Liberty's head
11 - [illegible] is swooped & the bartender likes giblets. Does what you would
12 - Bartender yells angrily while Steve fortifies the bar.
13 - [illegible]
14 → Bartender shot. This is [illegible]
15 - Max gets on subway. Rio dies.
16 - [illegible] grid. Subway passenger kid sees - Steve has to be happy that the [illegible]
17 - Max in the bar, WHY DOES HE LEAVE? Bar changes in order to [illegible]
18 - →
19
20
21 - Steve
22 - Steve looks outside - wet. Max sleeps - the boy reads [illegible]

#1 Pages 9-10-11

9 - Steve looks on fire escape
Pain - Flashback - what? There are a lot of ways to feel pain
Terror inside the window Not something it hurts more after it
the grabs body - [illegible] but you remember it.
Holding a head

10 - Steve looks in dumpster - holding a head screaming. In such a
His only holding her head.
Looks up to see [illegible]
Steve runs - he's still holding the head. Behind him monsters crawl
Flashback again.

11 - Steve is entering the street people are scared to [illegible]
FLASHBACK

A huge fear monster

Flashback is Steve leaving his apt & it's wrecked. He's making the
BIG decisions and ignoring the small ones.

I’ll write my story outline anywhere from 3-12 times. Each time, shuffling pages, or what I think I can fit into a page.

I like to get this tight before I start scripting.

Then, once it’s tight, I start the script...

Let’s Talk Deep Script Chat

If you want to write a comic then you need to learn how to script it because this isn’t prose, or poetry, or even the movies.

This is sequential narrative.

Writing A Comic Script

It is hard…

But anyone can do it…

And there are lots of ways to do it…

But there are universal rights and wrongs to the doing of it.

Here goes…:

Having An Idea

I’ll assume you have an idea.

If you don’t have one, make it up.

Even just a scene.

This isn’t going to be published.

Dear lord, don’t publish your first comic script.

Script Formatting

There’s no set industry standard to formatting your script.

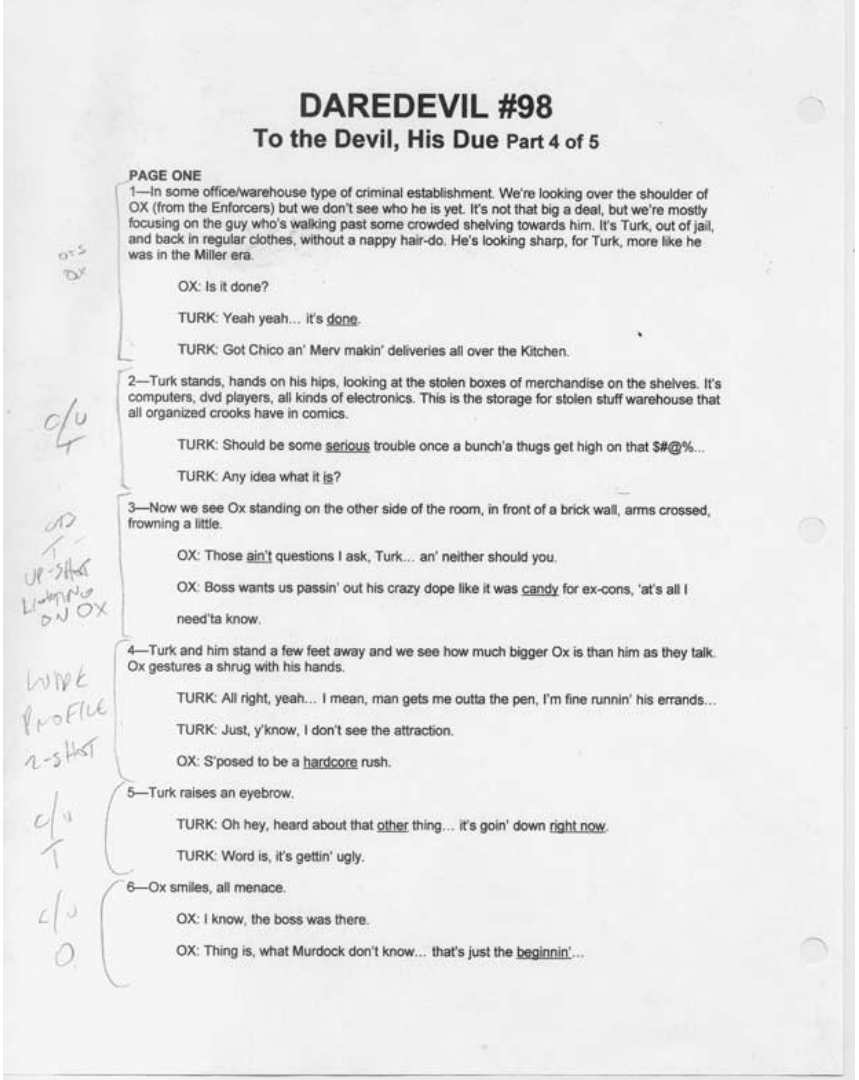
This is awesome and it frees you…

While it also cripples you with doubt.

It’s fun.

Let’s look at some.

This Ed Brubaker script was the first script I found online. It hung over my desk for years.
It is a good format.



DAREDEVIL #98

To the Devil, His Due Part 4 of 5

PAGE ONE

1—In some office/warehouse type of criminal establishment. We're looking over the shoulder of OX (from the Enforcers) but we don't see who he is yet. It's not that big a deal, but we're mostly focusing on the guy who's walking past some crowded shelving towards him. It's Turk, out of jail, and back in regular clothes, without a nappy hair-do. He's looking sharp, for Turk, more like he was in the Miller era.

OX: Is it done?

TURK: Yeah yeah... it's done.

TURK: Got Chico an' Merv makin' deliveries all over the Kitchen.

2—Turk stands, hands on his hips, looking at the stolen boxes of merchandise on the shelves. It's computers, dvd players, all kinds of electronics. This is the storage for stolen stuff warehouse that all organized crooks have in comics.

TURK: Should be some serious trouble once a bunch'a thugs get high on that $#@%...

TURK: Any idea what it is?

3—Now we see Ox standing on the other side of the room, in front of a brick wall, arms crossed, frowning a little.

OX: Those ain't questions I ask, Turk... an' neither should you.

OX: Boss wants us passin' out his crazy dope like it was candy for ex-cons, 'at's all I need'ta know.

4—Turk and him stand a few feet away and we see how much bigger Ox is than him as they talk. Ox gestures a shrug with his hands.

TURK: All right, yeah... I mean, man gets me outta the pen, I'm fine runnin' his errands...

TURK: Just, y'know, I don't see the attraction.

OX: S'posed to be a hardcore rush.

5—Turk raises an eyebrow.

TURK: Oh hey, heard about that other thing... it's goin' down right now.

TURK: Word is, it's gettin' ugly.

6—Ox smiles, all menace.

OX: I know, the boss was there.

OX: Thing is, what Murdock don't know... that's just the beginnin'...

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Breaking Down The Panel

Brubaker states the page (CAPS)

Then he states the panel number (numbered)

Then the panel description (for the artist)

Then the dialogue (indented - for the letterer)

Most scripts operate, somewhat, like this.

Let’s quickly look.

Ultimate lis

Page 2-

1- Ext. Queens Street- day

Big action. Its a car chase!!

Its a big police car chase right in the city, right in broad daylight. A beat up black hummer with a sun roof is careening down the street right for us.

Behind them three cop cars, sirens a blazing are tearing right after them.

The driver of the beat up black hummer is sweaty wide eyed panicked. He is driving like a maniac and shitting in his pants.

The SHOCKER is poking his torso out of the sunroof and blasting away.

This is the Shocker. In costume. Any costume will do. He's a running gag of completely terrible supervillian cliches and abilities.

Check past appearances. His costume and weapons get more and more outrageous and more and more about trying to mask his complete inability to get away with anything.

Shocker's vibro units are heated up and launching back at the coming cops cars.

People on the street are jumping out of the way. Cars serving off the street and onto the sidewalk to get out of their way.

Spx: weeeeoooooowwwwweeeeeooooowwweeeeeeeeeeeooooooooooo

Ca

PAGE ONE

1.1
1/12 PANEL: ON A TV-SCREEN IMAGE OF MARA, she of TEENAGE MUSIC INTERNATIONAL, striking some vogue-ish pop-star pose. Her outfit, some kind of PVC number with zippers and an inappropriate gloss, reveals the bare flesh of her middle, quite round with child. She's pregnant.

1 MARA (w/ music notes) I was seventeen... and I was bad...

1.2
1/12 PANEL: ON A TV-SCREEN IMAGE OF MEI, also of T.A.M.I., also dressed in a manner woefully inappropriate, and also pregnant. She too strikes a preening star pose as she sings:

2 MEI (w/music notes) With the first boy... I ever had...

1.3
1/12 PANEL: ON CASANOVA QUINN. He looks different now. And he looks sick. Really sick. Pale, sunken; he's wearing a paper hospital gown with some dull and dumb little pattern all over it. His chin tucked, he stares AT CAMERA from the tops of his eyes like a character in a Stanley Kubrick film. Unshaven. A mess. This is the sickest, unsexiest, uncoolest we've seen Casanova.

3 CAP (CASS) I think I'm dying.

Ca

ONE:
Looking at a TRANSPORT COFFIN as used by the United States Army for moving dead soldiers from the field. The COFFIN is actually a large rectangular box, gunmetal gray. The AMERICAN FLAG is draped over the coffin.

The COFFIN sits alone in an empty hangar. Heavy shadows.

1. CAPTION/Hill: "Commander Rogers?
2. CAPTION/Hill: "I have the casualty figures from the operation in Broxton.

TWO:
SIX SOLDIERS - mix gender and ethnicity, please - wearing DUTY FATIGUES (probably current digital camo) carry the COFFIN out of the hangar into the daylight. They carry the body with respect.

They pass other SOLDIERS, likewise in DUTY FATIGUES. Everyone has come to a stop, facing the coffin. ALL are SALUTING, right hands crisply to their foreheads.

3. CAPTION/Hill: "Looks like we got off light.
4. CAPTION/Hill: "Only one KIA. Body was found in a barbershop on Main Street...

Scalp(

Page One

Five Panels

1.1) Night. Mance and Hazel are struggling to walk through deep snow, wind whistling past, nothing but bare trees all around. They're both shivering cold, ice clinging to their noses, looking like they can't go much further. They're wearing coats and both are wrapped in blankets and quilts, but they're still not dressed warm enough to be walking around in this kind of weather.

1.2) Tight on them. Hazel looks like she's about to collapse. Mance has his arm around her, trying to keep her moving, but he doesn't look like he's got much left in the tank either.

HAZEL: Mance…

MANCE: Hazel, we gotta keep moving… We're almost…

1.3) Hazel collapses, pulling her husband down with her.

MANCE: Hazel!

Watchmen



ALAN MOORE

WATCHMEN ISSUE 1.

"AT MIDNIGHT, ALL THE AGENTS.." (26 PAGES)

PAGE 1.

(PANEL) 1.

ALRIGHT. I'M FYSCHED UP, I'VE GOT BLOOD UP TO MY ELBOWS, VEINS IN MY TESTH AND MY HELMET AND KNEEPADS SECURELY FASTENED. LET'S GET OUT THERE AND MAKE TROUBLE THIS FIRST PAGE IS A SERIES OF VERTICAL JUMPS THAT TAKE US UP IN A STRAIGHT PROGRESSION FROM A MINUTE AND MICROSCOPIC DETAILED VIEW OF THE GUTTERS OF NEW YORK UP TO A PANORAMIC SHOT LOOKING DOWN UPON THE ROOFTOPS OF THIS FAMILIAR AND YET CURIOUSLY ALTERED CITYSCAPE. IN THIS FIRST PANEL WE ARE LOOKING STRAIGHT DOWN AT A DRAIN OPENING IN A PERFECTLY ORDINARY GUTTER. TO THE RIGHT OF THE PICTURE THE ACTUAL OUTER WALL OF THE CURB DROPS DOWN AWAY FROM US LIKE A MINIATURE CLIFF. OVER MORE TOWARDS THE LEFT, DOWN AT THE BOTTOM OF THE PICTURE, WE CAN SEE THE OLD AND WORN METAL OF THE DRAIN COVER WITH SOLID DARKNESS VISIBLE BETWEEN ITS SLATS. UP AT THE TOP OF THE PICTURE WE CAN JUST SEE THE DIRTY GUTTER RUNNING DOWN TOWARDS THE MOUTH OF THE DRAIN AT THE BOTTOM. THERE ARE ONLY TWO ELEMENTS THAT SEPARATE THIS IMAGE FROM A STANDARD EVERDAY CLOSE-UP OF A DRAIN, AND THE FIRST OF THESE IS THE UNUSUAL AMOUNT OF BLOOD WHICH IS GUSHING DOWN THE AFOREMENTIONED APERTURE IN THE FIRST PICTURE. LIQUID FINGERS OF BLOOD, THICK AND BRILLIANT SCARLET, DRIBBLE DOWN THE WALL OF THE CURB OVER TO THE RIGHT. GARISH STREAKS OF BRILLIANT RED AGAINST THE MUTED CONCRETE-GRAY OF THE STONE THAT THEY TRICKLE DOWN ACROSS. THE GUTTER IS SIMILARLY FULL OF BLOOD, GURGLING HAPPILY TOWARDS THE DRAIN WHERE IT SPILLS OUT OVER THE METAL DRAIN COVERING AND DRIPS DOWN AS TINY GLINTING BEADS INTO THE DARKNESS BENEATH. THE SECOND ITEM OF REMARK IS A 1" DIAMETER SMILEY BADGE, COLORED A VIVID SUNSHINE YELLOW AS IT LAYS THERE IN THE GUTTER SMILING UP AT US AGAINST A BACKGROUND OF LURID BLOOD RED. IT HAS SOMEHOW LODGED IN THE GUTTER SO THAT IT WON'T GO DOWN THE DRAIN, AND SIMPLY REMAINS STUCK THERE, STARING UP AT US WITH ITS JARRINGLY INANE EXPRESSION. A SMALL SPLASH OF CRIMSON STAINS THE FRONT OF THE BADGE. A SINGLE TINY SPATTER ACROSS ONE BLACK CARTOON EYE OF THE FACE ON THE BADGE. THAT'S BASICALLY THE WHOLE OPENING IMAGE, UNLESS YOU WANT TO STICK A CANDY WRAPPER THAT'S ABOUT TO FLOAT DOWN THE DRAIN, IN WHICH CASE WE HAVE A PACKET OF MELTDOWNS, WHICH ARE LIKE TREETS (ENGLISH) OR M&M's (AMERICAN) ONLY WITH LITTLE BRIGHTLY COLORED ATOMIC SYMBOLS ON THE WRAPPING. ONLY INCLUDE CANDY WRAPPING IF IT DOESN'T DISTRACT FROM THE SIMPLICITY OF THE IMAGE WITH THE GUTTER, THE BLOOD AND THE BADGE, THOUGH, BECAUSE THIS IMAGE IS PRETTY IMPORTANT. IT GIVES US THE BLOOD SPATTERED SMILEY-BADGE, WHICH IS A PRETTY WORKABLE SYMBOL OF THE MYSTERY OF THE COMEDIAN'S MURDER WHICH RUNS THROUGH THE ENTIRE SERIES, AND IT ALSO GIVES US A FAINT SUBLIMINAL PREDICTION OF THE ENDING WITH IT'S IMAGE OF THE GUTTERS OF NEW YORK AWASH WITH BLOOD. ANYWAY, SEE WHAT YOU THINK AND LEAVE OUT THINGS LIKE THE SWEET WRAPPER IF YOU THINK THEY'RE EVEN SLIGHTLY DISTRACTING. WE'LL HAVE PLENTY OF TIME TO GET ALL OUR CUTE BRAND NAMES IN LATER ON IN THE SERIES. THE ACTUAL TEXT UPON THIS FIRST PAGE IS ALL TAKEN FROM RORSCHACH'S JOURNAL, WHICH WILL BE A MORE-OR-LESS CONTINUING FEATURE OF THE NARRATIVE THROUGHOUT THE SERIES. I MENTION THIS IN CASE YOU THINK IT MIGHT BE NICE TO VISUALLY DIFFERENTIATE BETWEEN ROBSCHACH'S JOURNAL AND ANY OTHER CAPTION BOXES THAT MIGHT OCCUR BY GIVING IT A SPECIFIC COLOR A SPECIFIC SHAPE OR LETTERING STYLE OR SOMETHING. I SUPPOSE IT'D BE NICE IF WE COULD ACTUALLY GET OVER SOME OF THE CHARACTER OF ROBSCHACH HIMSELF BY THE WAY HIS JOURNAL IS WRITTEN, ALTHOUGH I SUPPOSE A SUITABLY WARPED-LOOKING STYLE OF HAND WRITING MIGHT BE OFF-PUTTINGLY DIFFICULT TO READ OR TIME CONSUMING AND DIFFICULT TO MAINTAIN. MAYBE YOU COULD SUGGEST A SORT OF SCRUFFINESS WITHOUT GETTING TOO ELABORATE, THOUGH. PERHAPS A MORE RAGGED EDGE OR A FAINT SPATTERING OF MESSY INK BLOTS IN THE BOXES HERE AND THERE AS IF THEY'D BEEN LETTERED BY A PEN WITH A SPLIT NIB OR SOMETHING. ANYWAY. THE OPTIONS ARE THERE, SO JUST DO WHAT YOU WANT. IN FACT, IF YOUR ANXIOUS TO SEE ANYTHING THAT EVEN SMACKS OF VISUAL FLUMMERY THEN PLEASE FEEL FREE TO MAKE ROBSCHACH'S BOXES THE SAME AS EVERYONE ELSES AND RELY UPON THE TEXT IN THEM TO SET THEM APART FROM OTHER NARRATIVE WITHOUT IMPOSING ANY VISUAL GIMMICKS NEEDLESSLY. OKAY. THAT'S THE PREAMBLE OUT OF THE WAY. SO GIVE IT ALL YOU'VE GOT AND LETS SEE SOME GOOD DRAIN ART HERE.

CAP.: ROBSCHACH'S JOURNAL. OCTOBER 12th, 1985:

CAP.: "dog carcass in alley this morning, tire tread on burst stomach. This city is afraid of me. I have seen its true face.

My

A Rainbow Dash One-Shot by Ryan K Lindsay

PAGE 1 - 4 PANELS

1. We open on Tank. He is at some sort of air show out in the fields amongst a throng of onlooking ponies. Applejack's orchards frame the backdrop/horizon. He is hovering in the air and waving a flag emblazoned with "Go Rainbow Dash!" as a loud speaker announces the parade.

> Announcer: Here's the moment everypony's been waiting for, the reason for the season, the moment of bliss that looks like this...

2. The Wonderbolts fly over the crowd gathered to watch the show.

> Announcer: THE WONDERBOLTS!

3. The crowd goes wild.

> Announcer: And now the patron of this Summerfell Festival, the light refraction of satisfaction...

4. Rainbow hits a sonic RAINBOOM above the crowd as she slashes down on her guitar with her goggles on. The clouds disperse around her.

> Announcer: RAINBOW DASH with her always amazing, forever trailblazing SONIC RAINBOOM!

Harold Holt Script #1 Draft 2 - Ryan K Lindsay

Ha

PAGE 1 - 4 PANELS
PANEL ONE
Establishing shot of Cheviot Beach in Victoria. It's a nice December day and standing on the edge of the water is Harold Holt in his swimming dick stickers. He's tiny in this pic. The waves are choppy.

Caption: 1967
Caption: Harold Holt
Caption: Australian Prime Minister

PANEL TWO
Holt wades into the water - he's up past his knees.

Caption: Strong swimmer and skindiver.

PANEL THREE
Holt starts swimming freestyle through the choppy waves.

Caption: Missing at sea and presumed dead while still holding office.

It’s All Different

So long as you follow the method of:

State the page (CAPS)

State the panel number (numbered)

Panel description (for the artist)

Then the dialogue (indented - for the letterer)

you should be safe

HOWEVER - DIALOGUE ADDENDUM

Very recently, some letterers told me that indenting is a pain for their formatting and not to do it.

So, the more you know :D

I won’t be indenting again.

HOWEVER, then others said it didn’t matter :|

Do whatever you want :)

Script Toolbox

Once you know the format, there are plenty of little tools to help you along the way.

Let’s unpack some...

Script Toolbox - Dialogue

Is what the characters say authentic and necessary?

Or are they just saying things to push the story where you need it to go?

Your characters should each sound different.

Script Toolbox - Dialogue

Feel free to give your characters different things to fill their speech balloons.

Punctuation (!?) works well, as does an ellipsis (...) or just an empty balloon.

Feel free to think outside the box.

My



Script Toolbox - Captions

Captions can be:

- nondiagetic - setting the scene, time, etc
- inner monologue - basically replacing the old thoughtballoons
- omniscient narrator

None is right or wrong. But your story should match what you choose.

Script Toolbox - Silent Panels

Don’t be afraid to use them. Your words don’t need to be everywhere.

Personally, though, I like to consider the symmetry, and flow, of the page. Because I’m an idiot.

Script Toolbox - Gutters

Gutters are the spaces/gaps between panels.

You can use the gutters to let readers assume what happens between two images.

This means you don’t need to do ABCD storytelling.

A Script is for the Creative Team

Warren Ellis has written that the script needs to be a set of instructions that present the story with clarity.

Format helps this.

And your word choices help this.

Format

We’ve covered it.

Though I will add…

Put a page break between each page.

This helps to find pages easily.

CTRL+ENTER

Panel Descriptions

Only give what you need for the artist to be able to do their job.

Don’t clog it up with superfluous information, or purple prose.

In other words...

Be Like Greg Rucka...

Page 1

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Not Like Alan Moore

ALAN MOORE

WATCHMEN ISSUE 1.

"AT MIDNIGHT, ALL THE AGENTS.." (26 PAGES)

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Apocrypha states that one of Moore’s scripts asked the artist to show a man from behind, and then later in the same description asks us to be looking into his face.

What To Put In A Panel

One panel on your page should be one moment in time. The best moment to help move the story.

But it has to work with the entire page. So, before you write the first panel...

Think of the Whole Page

When planning a page, I like to think about the whole thing before I start.

Know where your page starts and ends.

Once you know ALL that will go in the page, you can spread out what needs to be shown to deliver that bit of story.

Page Structure

There are many ways to structure a page:

- Splash page - one panel
- 2-5 panels - kinda the norm
- 6-10 panels - dense storytelling
- 11+ panels - pushing the friendship

Let Story Inform the Page

You'll come to know how much story is needed on the page…

And how much real estate each moment needs.

PAGE ONE - PANEL ONE

That first image has to pop. It has to matter.

Think of your opening panel as being the contract you establish with the reader. This sets the tone, timbre, and meter of the entire story.

Dan Hill is writing amazing things about opening panels at The Weekly Crisis in his Opening Contract column.

If you don’t have perfection, just start scripting anyway.

It’s a first draft.

You can always edit, shuffle, tweak, massage, and change later on.

Some Tips

Some writers plot out the action first, balloons second.

Some writers write the dialogue of the scene out, then split it between panels.

Choose what suits you and the scene.

Writing is Rewriting

No one publishes their first draft.

Take a week away from your script.

Then read it and flag the parts that make you pause. You'll know them.

Make them better.

When Editing

Look to see if you can crop a panel - can two things be merged? Can one thing be dropped altogether?

Avoid ABCD storytelling, use your gutters. - the reader will fill in the gaps between.

Writing is Rewriting

Don’t be afraid to rewrite a scene completely.

Change the setting, or the POV character, or just write something else (something better) entirely.

Headspace #6

Finding Artists

Good.

Luck.

Seriously.

Finding Artists

I went years unable to find artists.

Or at least, the right artists for my projects.

It can feel really difficult because you’re no one starting out.

Where To Find Artists

Sites like DigitalWebbing and such exist for the purpose of hooking you up.

Artists use DeviantArt and Tumblr and their sites to host their art.

Browsing can take hours/days/your entire life.

My Tip

Find a rad artist - one good enough to already be making some comics and who charges a page rate - and then pay them to draw a short story of yours.

You’re paying for: professionalism, hitting deadlines, quality, and their fanbase.

Breaking In

Put your 60 issue epic away.

Seriously, put it away. Now.

No editor will look at a 60 issue treatment seriously from you.

Editors will only look at completed comic work.

Complete Your Comic Work

Start off by doing short stories:

5 page stories are hard to write, are fantastic at honing your skill, and are more likely to be drawn by an artist.

Then put them up online for free.

Murder Book - Clockwork

One-Shots

A single issue story is hard to tell right, and great when pulled off.

It shows editors you’re able to close.

You’ll get an artist to commit.

It’s been done by Sam Humphries, Becky Cloonan, and Paul Allor really well.

Progression

After making some shorts (online for free and all to see) and a one-shot or two (maybe even online for free there, too) and this could take YEARS -- then get it in front of the right eyes.

Sharing Your Work

Never spam anyone. Ever.

Seriously.

It’s unprofessional and pretty much never ever helps.

Do. Not. Spam.

I know you’re excited, but don’t do it.

Sharing Your Work

Share your book with creators you admire who it is reasonable to put into their hands - people on your level or maybe one step above.

Give the book to creators at cons - or take cards and email/link later.

Meeting Editors

Our best bet at meeting editors here is:

- Passing chat on social media
- When they come to our cons (relatively often)
- Through other creators

Meeting Editors

Don’t be pushy.

Always ask.

Be nice.

Follow up politely.

Remember, you matter little to them right now.

Oh, and do good work.

Realistic Expectations

I’ve been taking my writing game seriously since 2008.

Writing semi-regularly since 2004.

Writing to some degree all my life.

And that first stuff all stinks. Nearly all of it.

But it’s great practice.

Getting Paid Gigs

Do years of decent stuff.

Be nice.

Get lucky in the right place at the right time.

Ghost Town op.

MLP op.

Headspace op.

Inspiration

Walk away from the writing.

Read books, comics, articles, everything.

Watch movies, TV (oh, man, TV right now!), stuff online.

BUT!

Always create more than you watch.

Every Day

And write every day.

Even if just ten minutes at lunch.

Write every day and every day it gets easier.

I Could Go All Day

There are so many things we could discuss or debate about writing today.

I have presented what I believe to be the basics and I hope they help you.

Are There Any QUESTIONS?

WRITE.

:)